



ONE MANUSCRIPT, END TO END

A Book, Start to Finish

One Manuscript from Blank Project to Published Page

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2026 · examples assume Inkhaven 3.0.0 or newer

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Following One Book

The companion volume, **The Inkhaven Manual**, is a reference: it takes each feature in turn and tells you what it is and how to run it. This book does the opposite. It picks **one manuscript** and follows it — from the empty project on a Monday morning to a typeset PDF and a small web edition — reaching for each feature exactly when a real author would, and no sooner.

If you learn best by watching something get built, start here. You can read this book beside the manual (it points to the relevant chapter whenever it uses a feature in passing) or entirely on its own.

The book we are writing

Our example is a short fantasy mystery — long enough to exercise a world, a cast, and a secret; short enough to finish inside one volume.

TERM **The Ninth Lantern**

Nine lanterns ring the harbour town of Saltmarch, and for three hundred years no keeper has let one go dark. On the morning the story opens, the ninth lantern is cold — and the keeper who tended it is gone. A short mystery: a small town, a handful of suspects, a magic that runs on light, and a truth that someone has worked very hard to keep.

It is deliberately a work of fiction with **secrets and a cast**, because that is what exercises the most of Inkhaven — a world to keep consistent, characters who must each sound like themselves, and a reveal that no one may act on too early. If you write non-fiction, the **shape** of the journey is identical; where a step is fiction-specific (the world, who-knows-what, the voices) the text notes the non-fiction parallel.

The shape of the journey

• • • *From blank project to published book*

```
I    The Foundation ..... init the project · sketch the
world & cast
II   Drafting ..... write the opening · keep the facts
straight
III  The Middle ..... plant the secret (KEN) · voices &
threads
IV   Revision ..... the read-through · the editorial
pass ·
                                     did it get better?
V    Publishing ..... assemble the PDF · EPUB & the web
edition
```

Each part is a stage every book passes through. You will not use every Inkhaven feature to write **your** book — few books need all of them — but by the end of this one you will have seen where each fits in the arc of a manuscript, and be able to reach for the right one at the right time.

WHAT YOU LEARNED

- This book follows **one manuscript**, “The Ninth Lantern”, from `inkhaven init` to a published PDF — learning by watching a book get written.
- It is a companion to **The Inkhaven Manual**: the manual is the reference, this is the journey. Read either alone or side by side.
- The example is fiction with a world and a secret because that exercises the most of Inkhaven; the **arc** is the same for non-fiction, and the text notes the parallels.

A BOOK, START TO FINISH

PART I

The Foundation

CHAPTER 1

1

Starting the Project

`inkhaven init`, naming the book, and the first chapters — meeting the blank page as a tree of files.

CHAPTER 2

2

The World and the Cast

Sketching a small world in `world.hjson` and adding the people and places The Ninth Lantern needs before a word of prose.

PART II

Drafting

CHAPTER 3

3

Writing the First Chapters

The editor and the AI assistant in daily use — drafting the opening with semantic search and steerable help at hand.

CHAPTER 4

4

Keeping the Facts Straight

Recording the facts of the world and letting the continuity watch catch a slip the moment it is written.

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PART III

The Middle

CHAPTER 5

5

The Secret and Who Knows It

Planting the mystery — declaring who knows what and when, and letting KEN guard the reveal so no character acts on a fact too early.

CHAPTER 6

6

Voices and Threads

Giving the cast distinct voices with CHORUS, and tracking the plot threads from setup to payoff.

PART IV

Revision

CHAPTER 7

7

The Read-Through

Reading the finished draft forward, once, as a first reader — finding where it sags and where it confuses.

CHAPTER 8

8

The Editorial Pass

Turning the readers' findings into confirmed changes, one worklist at a time, with every edit diff-reviewed.

CHAPTER 9

9

Did It Get Better?

Marking a milestone and measuring the revision — what cleared, and what quietly crept in.

PART V

Publishing

CHAPTER 10

10

Assembling the Book

From the tree to a Typst directory to a finished, typeset PDF.

CHAPTER 11

11

Out Into the World

An EPUB and a small web edition — sending The Ninth Lantern to its readers.

AFTERWORD

About the author



Vladimir Ulogov.

Vladimir Ulogov has spent decades building infrastructure for distributed systems — the kind of software that watches other software. Early in his career he worked on monitoring and telemetry platforms; later years took him into federated observability, telemetry buses, and the architecture of systems that have to make sense of millions of data points without losing the thread.

Observability, in the end, is the art of **holding a system too large for one head** — of watching it without losing the thread, and never reporting a thing it cannot back up. It is not an accident that a tool he built for writers carries the same instinct to the desk: a book, past a certain size, is exactly such a system, and it too

deserves an instrument that holds it for you.

What makes him slightly unusual in his corner of the industry is a tendency to write his own tools — not in the sense of small utilities, but in the sense of programming languages. The Bund language (its compiler, its VM, its document store, its parser) lives in a long series of Rust crates on crates.io. `rust_dynamic`, `rust_multistack`, `rust_multistackvm`, `bundcore`, `zbus_universal_data_gateway` — each is a building block that exists because the off-the-shelf options didn’t fit the shape of the work.

Why Inkhaven exists

Inkhaven is Vladimir’s personal reflection on how a single tool can hold the **whole** of writing a book. The frustration it answers is one every long-form writer knows: that the work is scattered across a dozen apps that don’t talk to each other — a browser for research, one program for the prose, another for the characters, a spreadsheet for the word count, a design tool for the final typesetting — and every seam between them is a place the book leaks.

Inkhaven’s wager is that all of it belongs in one place, next to the keyboard: the prose and the world it is set in, the facts it must not contradict, the assistant you steer, and the finished PDF. Not because integration is elegant, but because a book past a certain size outgrows the mind writing it, and a tool that holds your words should also be able to **hold the book** — its facts, its continuity, its shape — so the writer is free to do the one thing no tool can, which is write.

A work of love

Inkhaven is open source. The licence is permissive — you can read it, fork it, study it, modify it, and pass it on. Strictly speaking, the licence also lets you sell it. The author would, gently but firmly, disagree with you doing that. Inkhaven was not designed as a *for sale* project. It is a work of love made for the authors who can least afford to pay for software, and turning it into a commercial product would betray the reason it exists. So please — don’t.

It carries no analytics, no telemetry, no upsell. The binary will never phone home; the project will never have an “Enterprise” tier you have to escape from.

This was a deliberate choice. There are excellent commercial tools for writing. They cost money — which is fine for many writers, and a barrier for many more. Inkhaven exists for the second group: for the graduate student writing a dissertation on a battered laptop, for the novelist who shouldn't have to pick between rent and software, for the engineer drafting in the same terminal where they already write code, for anyone who would benefit from a tool that respects their work without asking for a credit-card number.

A note on cooperation

Vladimir believes firmly in the human capacity for mutual help — that we make better work, and live better lives, when we share what we know and what we build. Open source is one of the most concrete expressions of cooperation our era has produced: code read, improved, and passed forward without payment, without permission, by people who will never meet.

If Inkhaven helps you finish your book — that is enough. If it gives you a chord pattern you adapt into your own tool — that's a gift back to the larger project of making software writers can love. As a society, we achieve the greatest things when we help each other rather than compete with each other.

Where to find more

GitHub	@vulogov — the source for Inkhaven, Bund, and the dozen-plus Rust crates that carry the infrastructure. Issues and PRs welcome.
LinkedIn	/in/vladimirulogov — posts on observability, the occasional long-form essay.
YouTube	@vulogov — talks and walkthroughs from the conference trail.
X / Twitter	@vladimir_ulogov

If a fact you grounded ever surprises you, or a command trips you up and you can't find the answer in this book — open an issue on GitHub. The author reads them.

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